Johnson C. Smith University

Department of Health & Human Performance | Sport Management Program

SPM 435-A: Sport Sociology and Ethics (3 Credit Hours)

Academic Term: Fall Semester | **Instructor:** Micah J. Dobson, Ph.D. | **Email:** mdobson@jcsu.edu

Designed and taught by the applicant at JCSU; adapted with an international COIL crosswalk for this proposal.

1. Course Description & Learning Outcomes

Course Description

This course offers an introduction to the sociological and ethical issues prevalent in the sport industry. The values of sport and the bases for ethical decision-making and moral significance will be discussed. Students will also gain an understanding of the philosophical and ethical background of the sport context.

Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Critically analyze and evaluate sports from a sociological perspective.
- Appreciate and learn from the views of others as well as understand the limitations of one's own perspective.
- Effectively use written and oral forms of communication to make an objective argument, synthesize material from various sources, and explore intellectual problems.
- Actively collaborate with peers (including international cohorts) to deepen understanding of course material.

2. Required Texts & Evaluation Scheme

Required Texts and Resources

- **Textbook:** Woods, R. B., & Butler, B. N. (2024). *Social Issues in Sport* (5th ed.). Human Kinetics.
- **Supplemental Readings (Canvas):** Selected NCAA Division II diversity publications and South African Department of Sport, Arts and Culture (DSAC) Transformation Audits.

Grading Scheme and Key Assessments

- **Chapter Review Questions (10%):** Weekly critical reflections on assigned readings.
- **Weekly Discussion Boards / COIL Forums (10%):** Substantive weekly discussions. During the COIL exchange, prompts will connect directly with UWC student reflection threads.
- **Case Studies (20%):** Two comprehensive analyses examining topics such as media framing, sport fandom, and community athletic inclusion.
- **Midterm Presentation (20%):** Individual oral presentations on assigned sociological topics.
- **Final Research Assignment / Joint Policy Brief (30%):** A comprehensive capstone project analyzing community sports equity and administrative governance. Executed as a paired transatlantic policy brief with UWC scholars.
- **Attendance & Participation (10%)**

3. Proposed International Curriculum Crosswalk

Authorship & Adaptation Disclosure (Note to Reviewers)

This syllabus was designed by the applicant and is based on a course taught at Johnson C. Smith University (SPM 435: Sport Sociology and Ethics). The international COIL integration framework and transatlantic curriculum crosswalk detailed below have been newly developed specifically for this Fulbright U.S. Scholar proposal. Pending confirmation of an award, this course will incorporate a Collaborative Online International Learning (COIL) module connecting JCSU students with University of the Western Cape (UWC) honours students in SRE 743 (Sociology of Sport), co-taught with Dr. Makhaya Malema.

Transatlantic Thematic Curriculum Crosswalk (JCSU ↔ UWC)

The following crosswalk maps the pedagogical alignment between JCSU SPM 435 and UWC SRE 743, demonstrating the structural feasibility of our virtual exchange.

JCSU SPM 435 Weekly Focus (Dr. Dobson)	**UWC SRE 743 Module Topic** (Dr. Malema)	**Joint Transatlantic COIL Bridge Focus**
Wk 1: Sport and How We Study It	Unit 1: Origins & evolution of sport sociology	Comparative sociological methods in U.S. and African contexts.
Wk 4: Youth Sports and Development	Unit 3: Sociological & community development theories	Sport-for-Development (SfD): Grassroots youth sports delivery.
Wk 7: International Sports & Olympics	Unit 4: Sport and society in SA and international contexts	Post-colonial athletic systems and globalization pressures.
Wks 8–9: Race, Ethnicity & Gender	Unit 5: Sport participation in a multicultural society	**COIL Core 1:** Legacies of HBCU athletic resistance and SA anti-apartheid boycotts.
Wks 14–16: Politics, Policy, Deviance	Unit 6: Critical challenges facing SA sport	**COIL Core 2:** NCAA compliance models vs. SA's National Sport and Recreation Plan.
Wk 11: Social Class and Sport	Unit 8: Social research on class, poverty, and conflict	**COIL Core 3:** Socioeconomic barriers and community sports leadership.
Final Term Assignment	Final Assessment: Capstone Project	**Collaborative Capstone:** Joint Transatlantic Youth Sport Equity Policy Brief.

4. Course Schedule (16 Weeks)

- **Week 1:** Chapter 1: Sport and How We Study It
- **Week 2:** Chapter 2: Impact of Sport Participants and Spectators
- **Week 3:** Chapter 3: Impact of Sport Business, Management, and Media
- **Week 4:** Chapter 4: Youth Sports and Development Through Sport (Case Study #1)
- **Week 5:** Chapter 5: Coaching and Leadership in Sports

- **Week 6:** Chapter 6: Interscholastic and Intercollegiate Sport
- **Week 7:** Chapter 7: International Sports and the Modern Olympic Games

WEEKS 8 & 9: TRANSATLANTIC COIL LAUNCH WINDOW
Direct synchronization with UWC SRE 743. Joint asynchronous forums and co-instructed synchronous seminars focus on comparative equity.

- **Chapter 8:** Sporting Behavior, Ethics, and Moral Behavior
- **Chapter 9:** Race, Ethnicity, and Sport
- **Chapter 10:** Gender and Sport
- **Milestone:** Midterm Presentations delivered.

- **Week 10:** Fall Break
- **Week 11:** Chapter 11: Social Class and Sport (Case Study #2)
- **Week 12:** Chapter 12: Sport Experiences for Special Populations and Older Adults
- **Week 13:** Chapter 13: Religion and Sport
- **Weeks 14–16:** Politics, Policy, Deviance & Future Trends (Chapters 14–16)
- **Final Week:** Final Course Synthesis; Joint Transatlantic Policy Brief Due.

5. Institutional Policies

Standard Johnson C. Smith University (JCSU) institutional policies regarding the Honor Code, Academic Integrity, AI Usage, ADA Accommodations, and Student Counseling services apply in full.